



Restoration of a National Treasure - The Gulf of Mexico - "America's Sea"

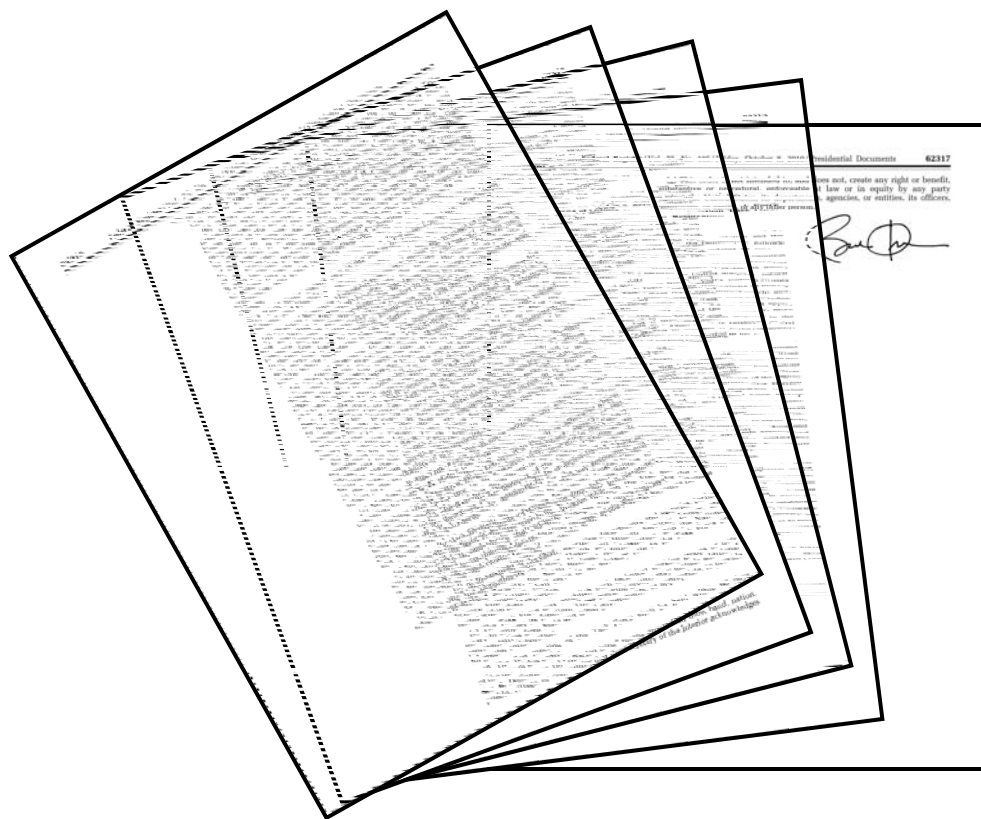


Bryon Griffith

Gulf of Mexico Ecosystem Restoration Task Force

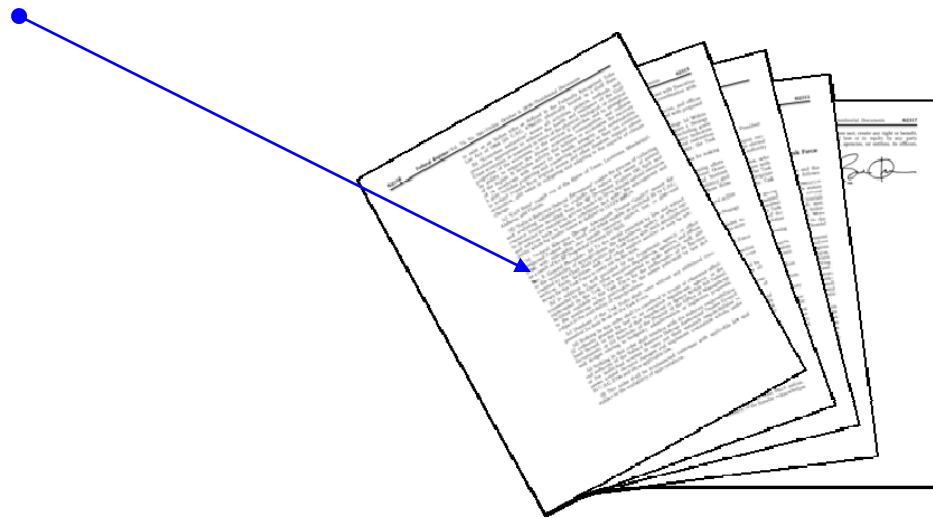


“The Gulf Coast is a national treasure. Its natural resources are an important economic engine for the entire United States; its waters sustain a diverse and vibrant ecosystem; and the Gulf’s culture, natural beauty, and historic significance are unique.”



**Executive Order 13554 of
October 5, 2010
Establishing the Gulf Coast
Ecosystem Restoration Task
Force**

*“To effectively address the damage caused by the BP Deepwater Horizon Oil Spill, address the longstanding ecological decline, and begin moving toward a more resilient Gulf Coast ecosystem, **ecosystem restoration is needed.**”*





Legislative & Executive Branch Integration

**Incident
Recovery**



**Ecosystem
Restoration**



**Emergency
Response /
Incident
Recovery**
(OPA 90):



**Ecosystem
Restoration**
(E.O. 13554):



Emergency
Response /
Incident
Recovery
(OPA 90):

Incident Recovery

(BP Deepwater
Horizon Oil Spill)

- Deep Water
Horizon Spill
Response





Emergency
Response /
Incident
Recovery
(OPA 90):

Incident Recovery

(BP Deepwater
Horizon Oil Spill)

- Deep Water
Horizon Spill
Response
- Natural
Resource
Damage
Assessment





Emergency
Response /
Incident
Recovery
(OPA 90):

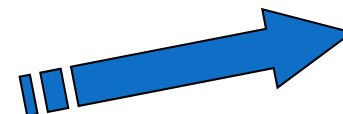
Incident Recovery

(BP Deepwater
Horizon Oil Spill)

- Deep Water
Horizon Spill
Response
- Natural
Resource
Damage
Assessment
- Economic
Impact
Recovery

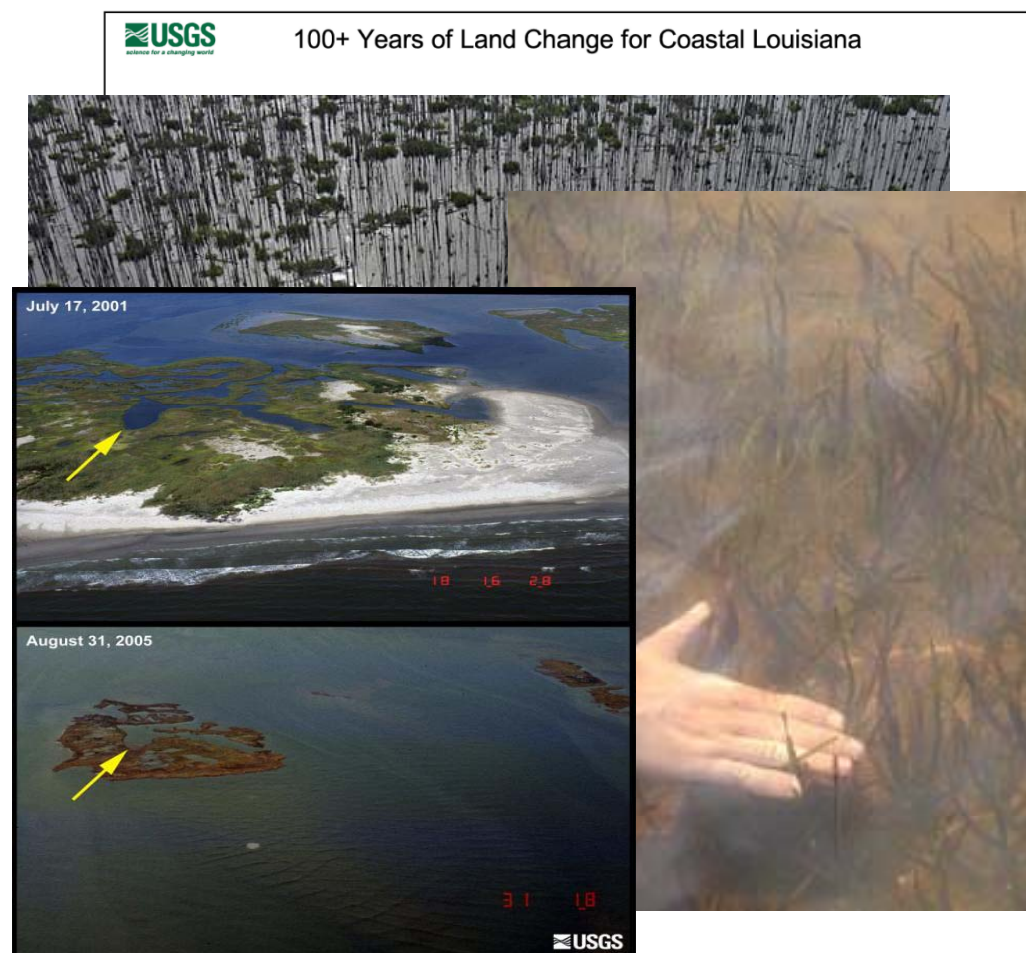


Ecosystem Restoration



Ecosystem Restoration (E.O. 13554):

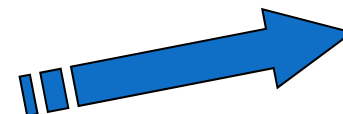
-  Habitat
-  Land Loss





Emergency
Response /
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Recovery
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Ecosystem Restoration

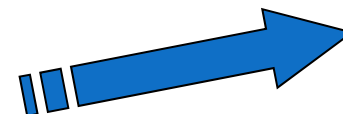


Ecosystem
Restoration
(E.O. 13554):

- Habitat
- Land Loss
- Water Quality

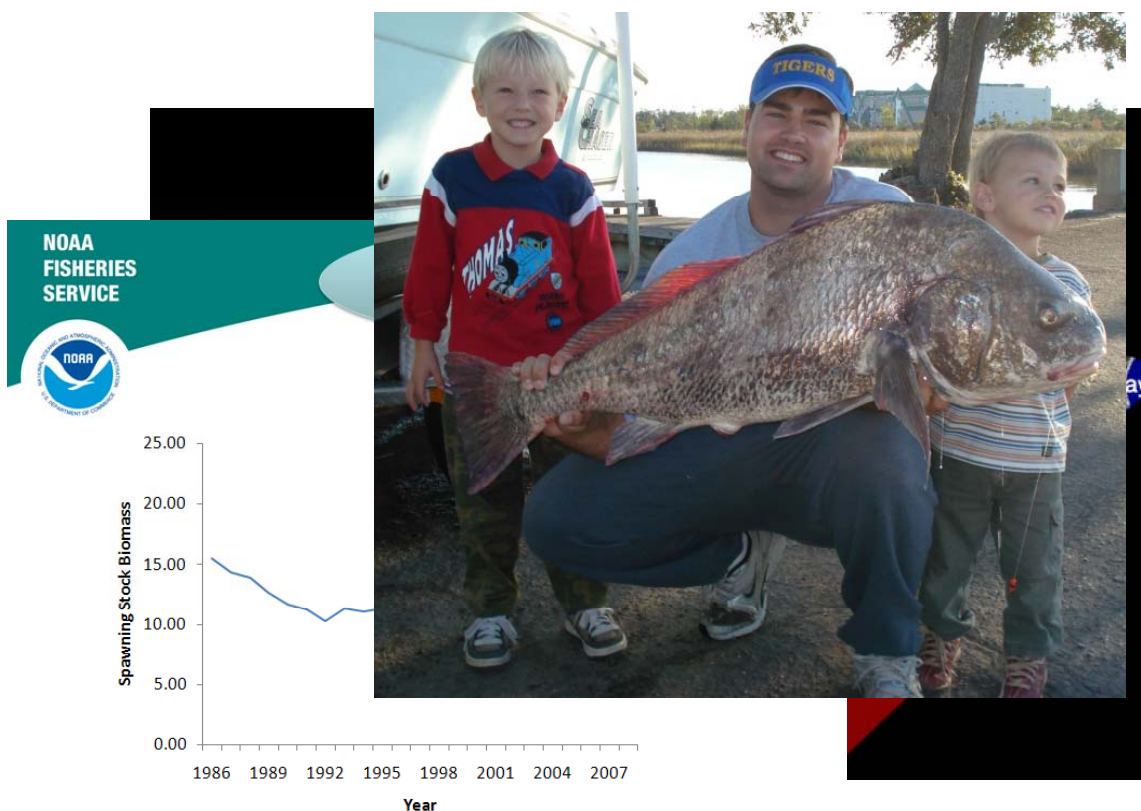


Ecosystem Restoration

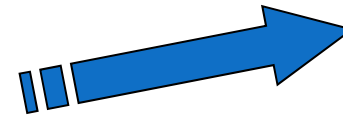


Ecosystem Restoration (E.O. 13554):

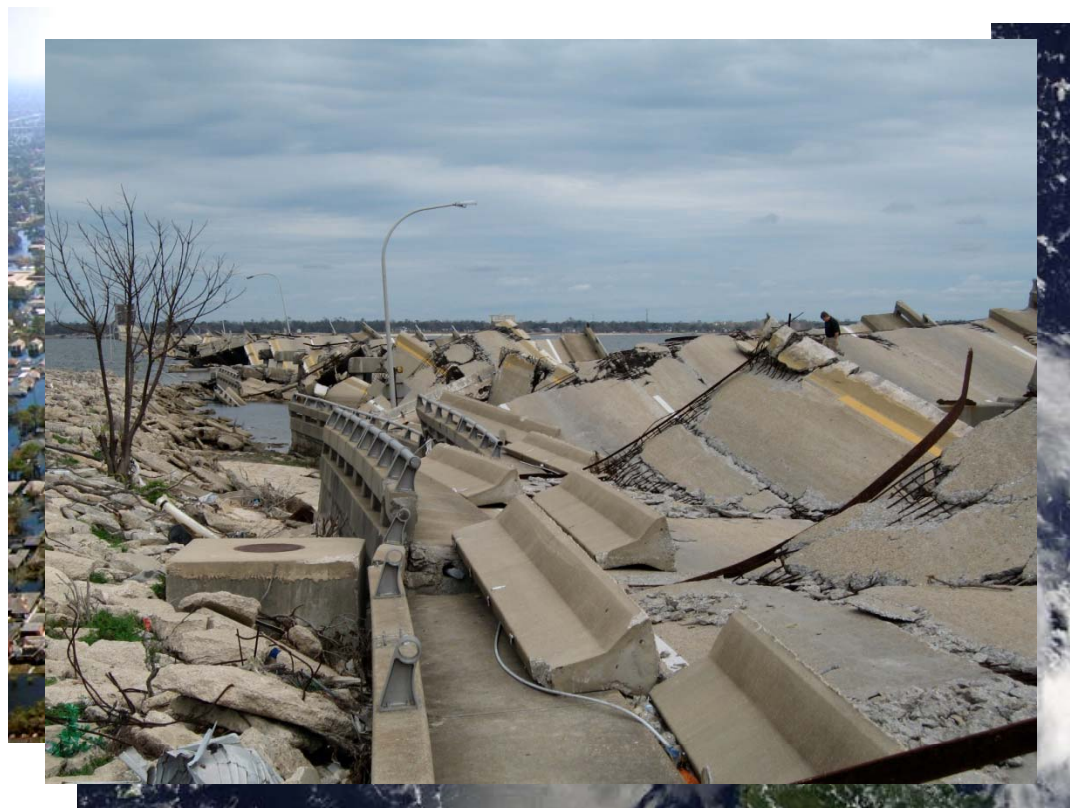
- Habitat
- Land Loss
- Water Quality
- Fisheries



Ecosystem Restoration



**Ecosystem
Restoration
(E.O. 13554):**



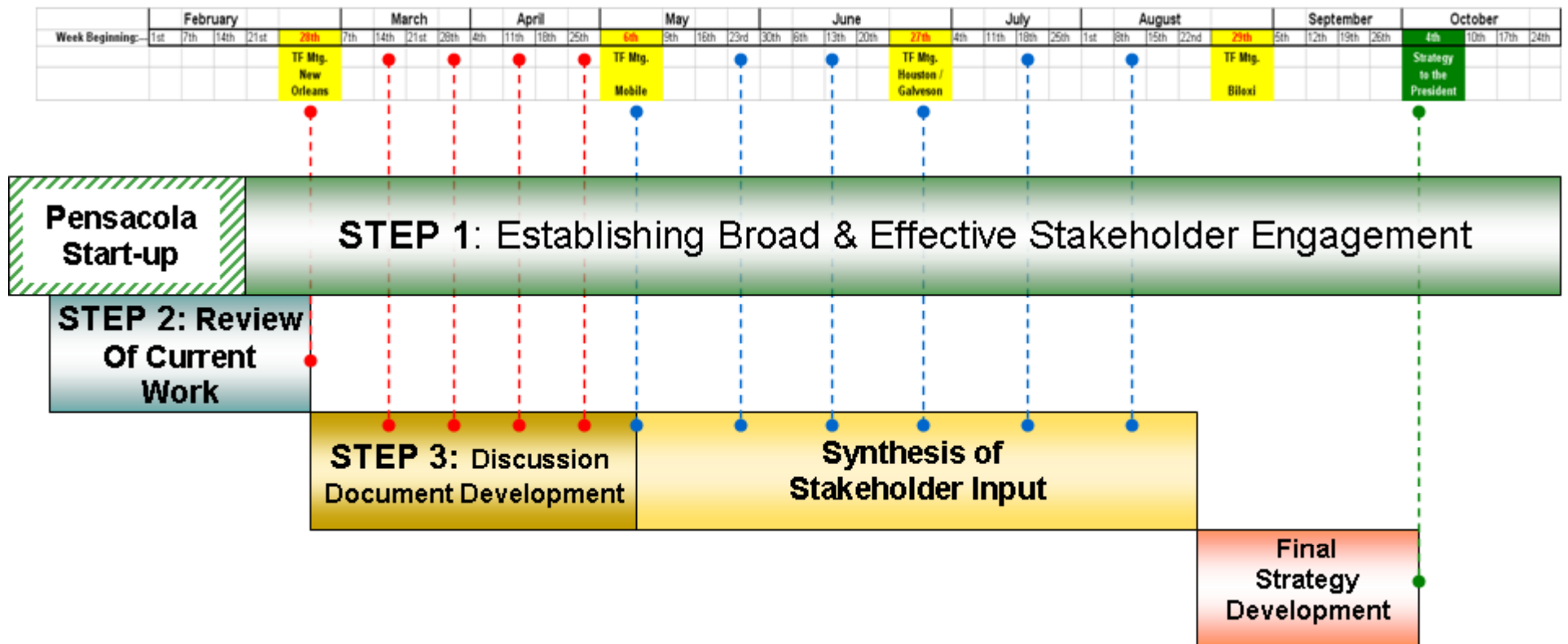
- Habitat
- Land Loss
- Water Quality
- Fisheries
- Climate Adaptation
- Sustainable Communities



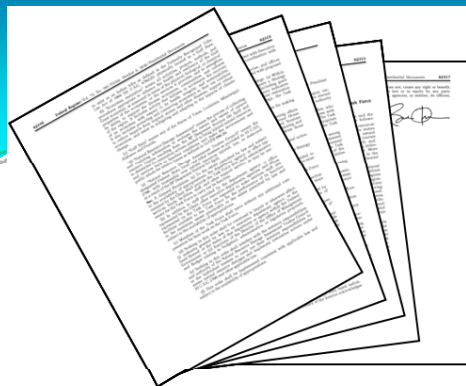
The Key Initial Challenge

On **(October 4, 2011)**, this Task Force will submit to the President a **Gulf of Mexico Regional Ecosystem Restoration Strategy**.

Strategy Development Schedule:



Step 1 – Establish Broad and Effective Stakeholder Engagement



Engage stakeholders throughout the region in the development of the strategy



Integration of Stakeholder Input:

Public - NGOs

Local Govt.

Academia

Business & Ind.

Communities

Step 1 – Establish Broad and Effective Stakeholder Engagement

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- Local Govt.
- Academia
- Business & Ind.
- Communities

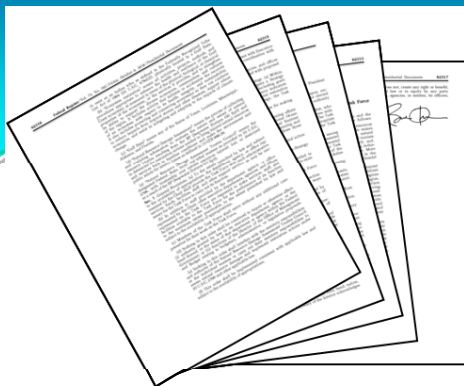
Step 1

Strategy Development Schedule:

[illegible]

Pensacola Start-up

STEP 1: Establishing Broad & Effective Stakeholder Engagement

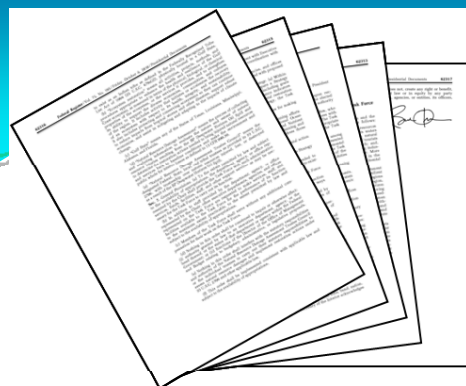


Step 2 – Assess What is Currently Being Done to Address Restoration

In developing the Strategy, the Task Force Shall:

Consider existing research and ecosystem restoration planning efforts in the region

Step 2 – Assess What is Currently Being Done to Address Restoration



Synthesis of Existing Restoration Plans / Programs

National

Regional

Local

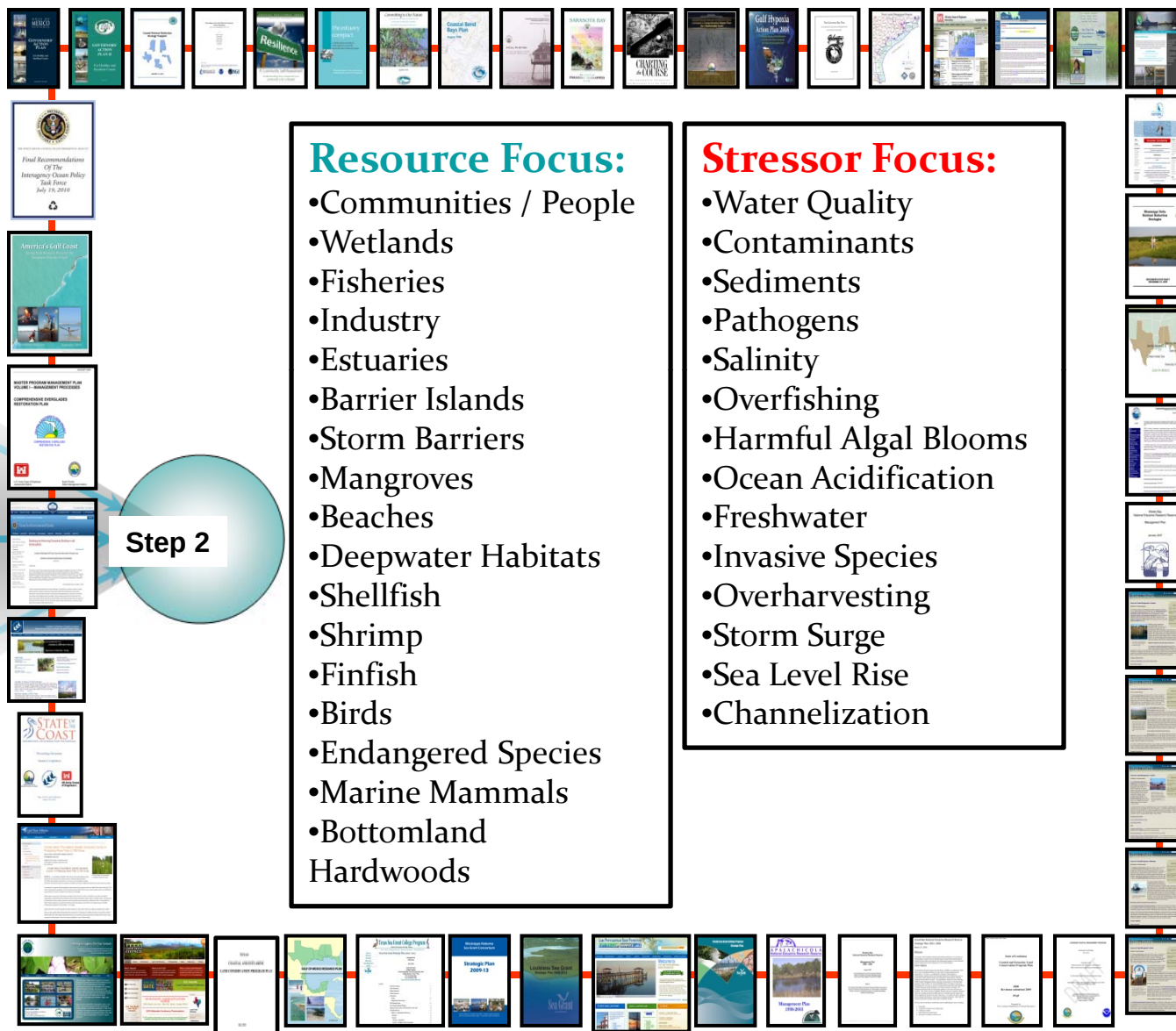
Step 2

Resource Focus:

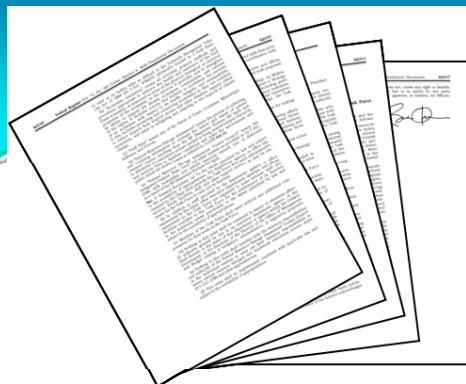
- Communities / People
- Wetlands
- Fisheries
- Industry
- Estuaries
- Barrier Islands
- Storm Barriers
- Mangroves
- Beaches
- Deepwater Habitats
- Shellfish
- Shrimp
- Finfish
- Birds
- Endangered Species
- Marine Mammals
- Bottomland Hardwoods

Stressor Focus:

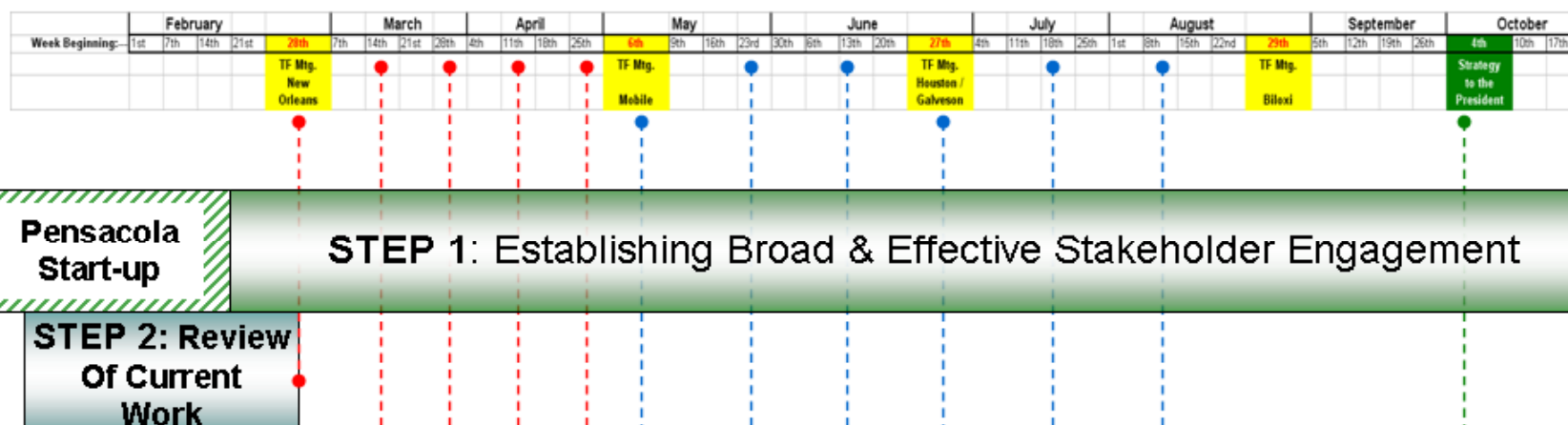
- Water Quality
- Contaminants
- Sediments
- Pathogens
- Salinity
- Overfishing
- Harmful Algal Blooms
- Ocean Acidification
- Freshwater
- Invasive Species
- Overharvesting
- Storm Surge
- Sea Level Rise
- Channelization



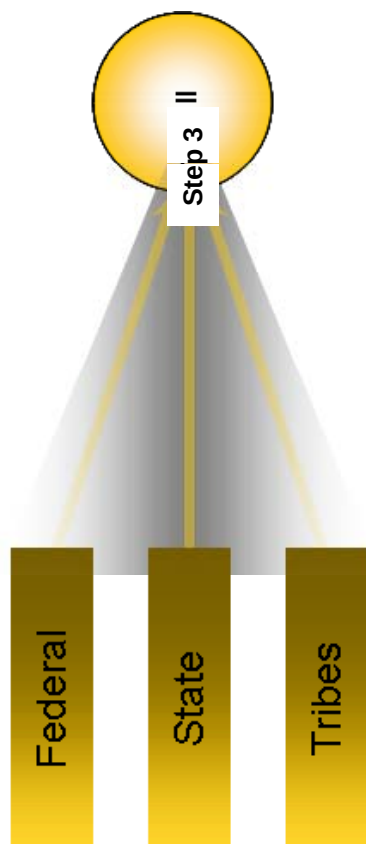
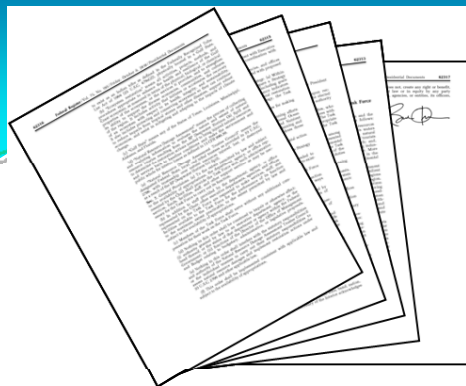
Step 2 – Assess What is Currently Being Done to Address Restoration



Strategy Development Schedule:



Step 3 – Coordinate and Integrate Federal, State and Tribal Priorities - (Discussion Document)



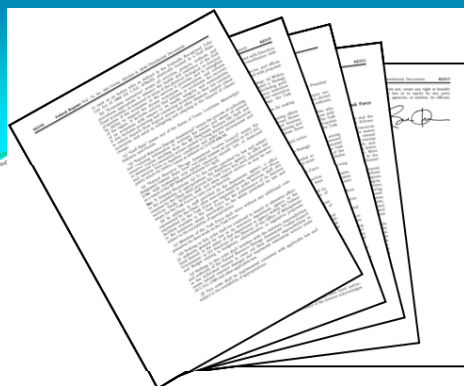
Integration of Federal, State and Tribal Priorities

Identify monitoring, research, and scientific assessments needed to support decision making;

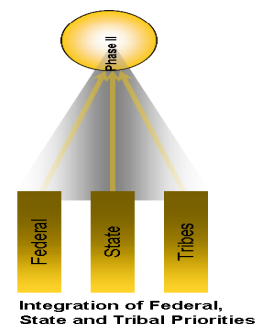
Evaluate existing monitoring programs and gaps in current data collection;

Define ecosystem restoration goals and describe milestones;

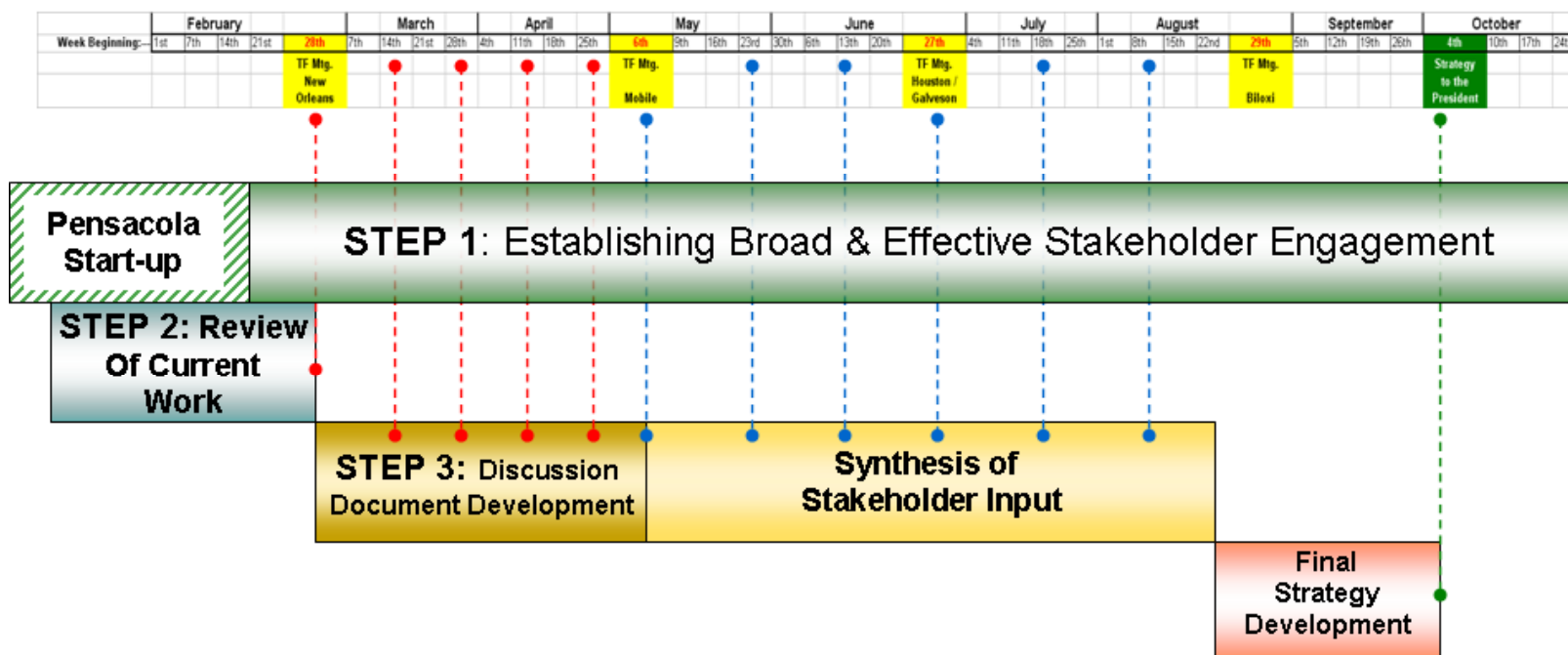
Identify major policy areas where Coordinated intergovernmental action is necessary;



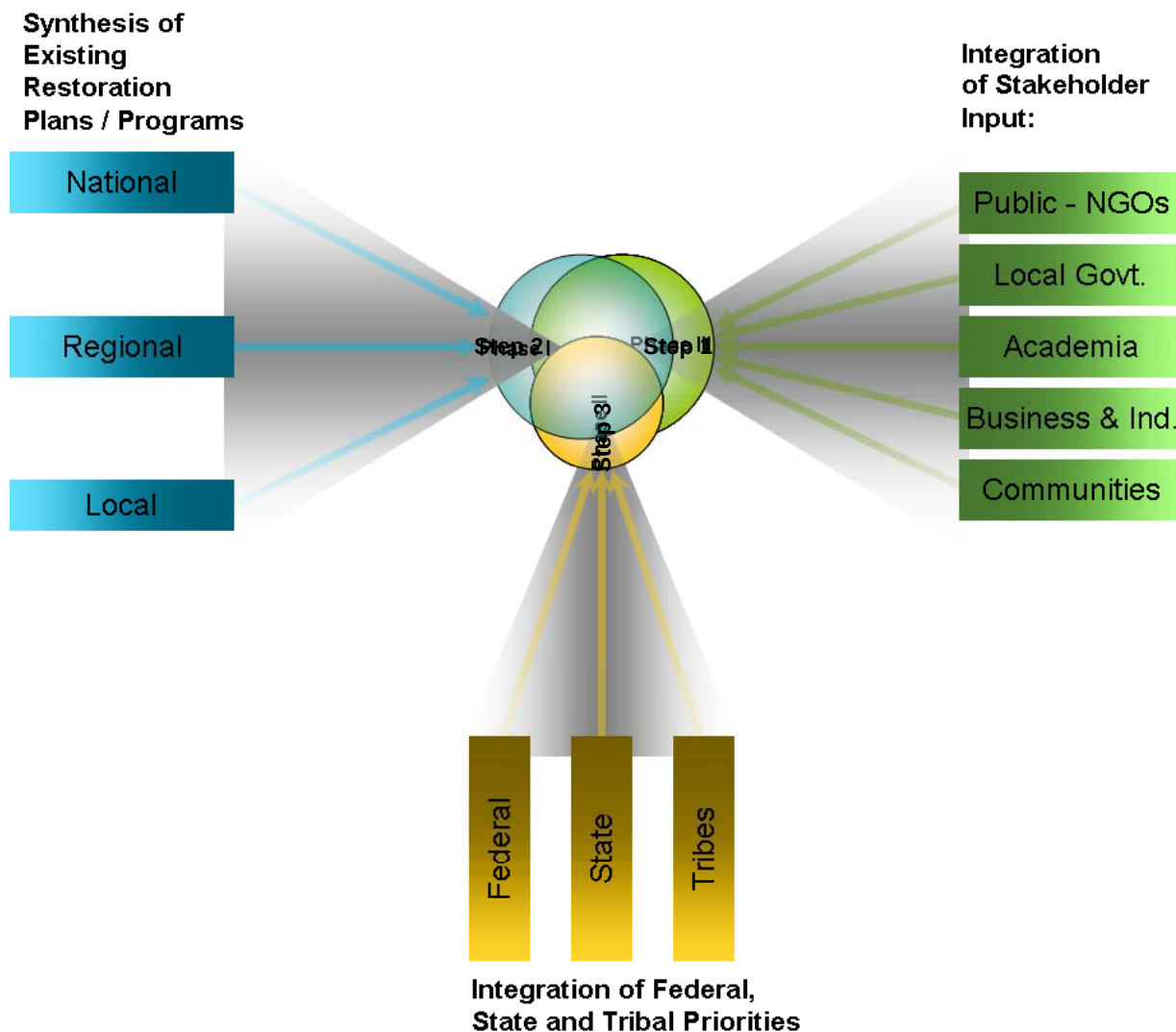
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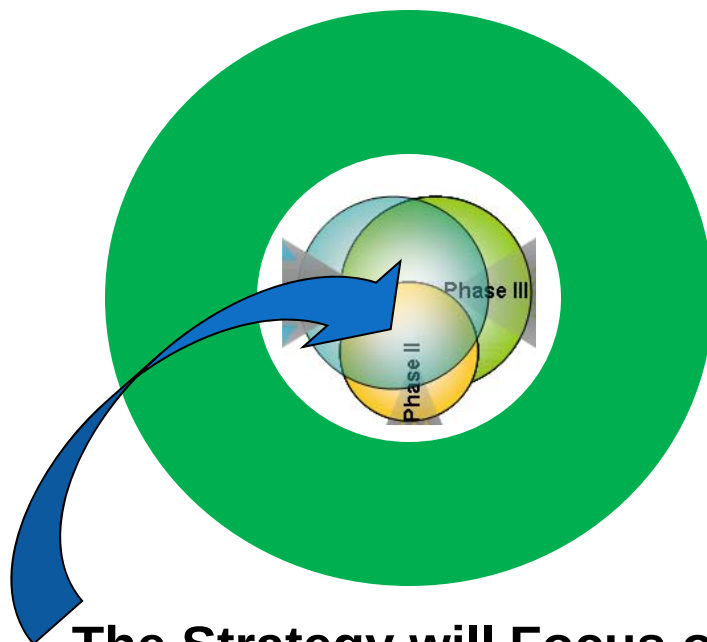


Strategy Development Schedule:



Merger of the Three Steps will Reveal Shared Priorities and Capacities:





**The Strategy will Focus on
Shared Priorities and the Supporting Actions and
Tactics Most Capable of Advancing
Gulfwide Restoration**